

We've now encountered the main arguments for the view
that you are, either entirely or in part, an immaterial
thing.

We have already encountered two kinds of arguments
against that view.

The first are the “easy arguments” for materialism. Those seem to be more of a problem for the simple believer in immaterial souls than for the fusion believer in immaterial souls.

The second is the argument that we should not believe in souls for the same reason we don't believe in fairies: there is no good evidence for their existence. That might be countered with the knowledge argument or the conceivability argument.

Let's turn to a second kind of argument against soul-based survival theories: **swapping arguments**. We already saw an example of these in Locke's argument against

Consider the following example.

Let's call Ferdinand before the accident "Ferdinand-" and
Ferdinand after the accident "Ferdinand+".

Psychology-swapping

Ferdinand is a combination of a soul and a body. Suppose that Ferdinand suffers an accident which entirely changes his psychology. He has none of his former memories, and none of his former personality traits. He used to be very selfish; he's now very generous. He used to be best friends with Jane; now he finds Jane annoying, and prefers to spend time with Maria.

part) an immaterial soul.

Let's suppose that the view that there are immaterial

soul is true. Then your roommate is (either wholly or in

thing.

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Let's look at some others.

the same apparent memories and personality.

should connect to your roommate's body could have

been swapped out for a different one which has exactly

Here is something that seems possible: last night, the

You would, it seems, have no way of telling whether this

happen. So, you don't know whether you have the same

roommate as you did yesterday.

happened. So you have no evidence that it did not

But of course you do know this. So the view that there

are immaterial, so must be false.

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More dramatically, the soul attached to your body

happened. After all, the new soul (which you are) could

have been given the same personality and apparent

could have been swapped out last night. It seems that

memories as the old soul.

So you do not know whether you have been attached to

this body for more than a day. But of course you do

than a day. So, the view that there are immaterial souls

must be false.

know that you have been attached to this body for more

Call this argument from soul-switching. How

should the believer in immaterial souls respond?

Here is some what related argument.

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